

---BREAKDOWNS---

The Big Sciota

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

The main melody and accompaniment for 'The Big Sciota' are presented in four staves. The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The tempo is marked as 105 beats per minute. The melody is written in treble clef, and the accompaniment is in bass clef. The melody features a series of eighth and sixteenth notes, with a triplet of eighth notes at the end of the first line. The accompaniment consists of chords and single notes, with a final double bar line and repeat sign at the end of the fourth staff.

Chords: G, G/F#, G, G/A, G, G, C, D, D, D, Em, Em, C, D, D, G.

Variation 1

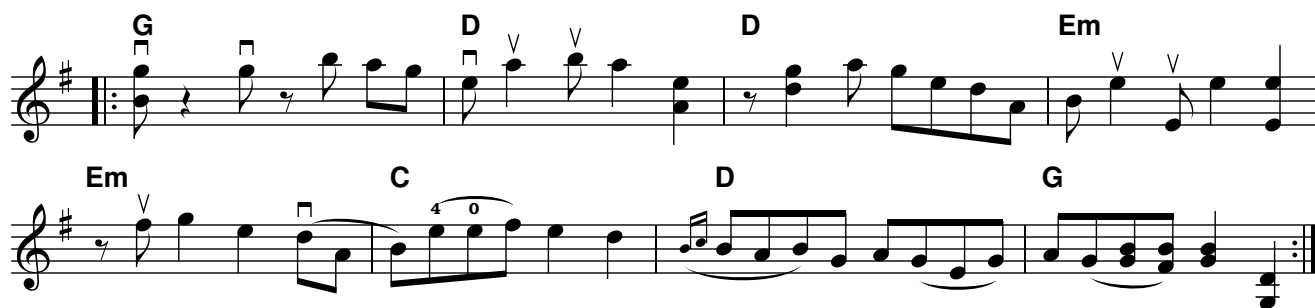
Variation 1 of 'The Big Sciota' is presented in four staves. The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The tempo is marked as 105 beats per minute. The melody is written in treble clef, and the accompaniment is in bass clef. The melody features a series of eighth and sixteenth notes, with a triplet of eighth notes at the end of the first line. The accompaniment consists of chords and single notes, with a final double bar line and repeat sign at the end of the fourth staff.

Chords: G, G/F#, G, G/A, G, G, C, D, D, D, G, G, D, D, Em, Em, C, D, D, G.

Variation 2

Variation 2 of 'The Big Sciota' is presented in two staves. The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The tempo is marked as 105 beats per minute. The melody is written in treble clef, and the accompaniment is in bass clef. The melody features a series of eighth and sixteenth notes, with a triplet of eighth notes at the end of the first line. The accompaniment consists of chords and single notes, with a final double bar line and repeat sign at the end of the second staff.

Chords: G, G/F#, G, G/A, G, G, C, D, G.



Notes: Named after the Scioto River in Ohio. Also spelled Scioti, Scioty, etc.

Neat tune! Simple in its basic form, but it has really grown on me. I'm afraid I don't know if there's a "standard" form of the tune; this is just me cobbling together what I've heard and what I've invented on top of it.

Bitter Creek

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

G C G D

G C D G

G C G D

G C D G

{B}

G C G D

G C D G

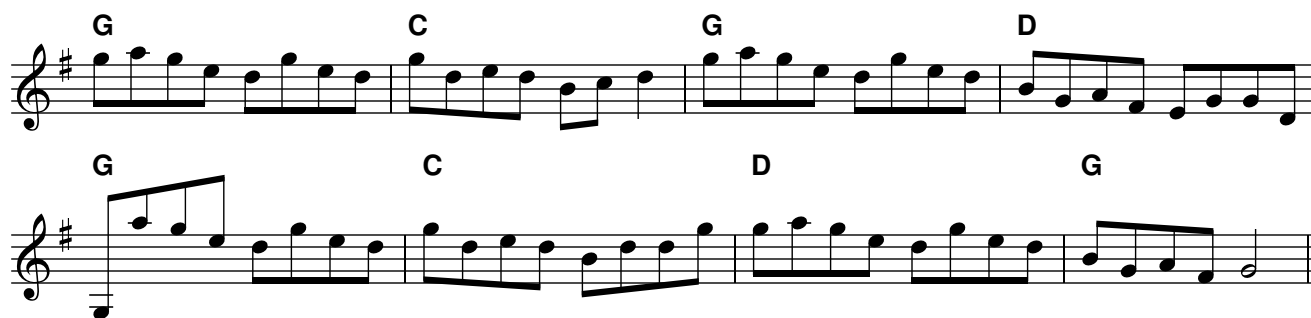
G C G D

G C D G

{A} (var.)

G C G D

G C D G

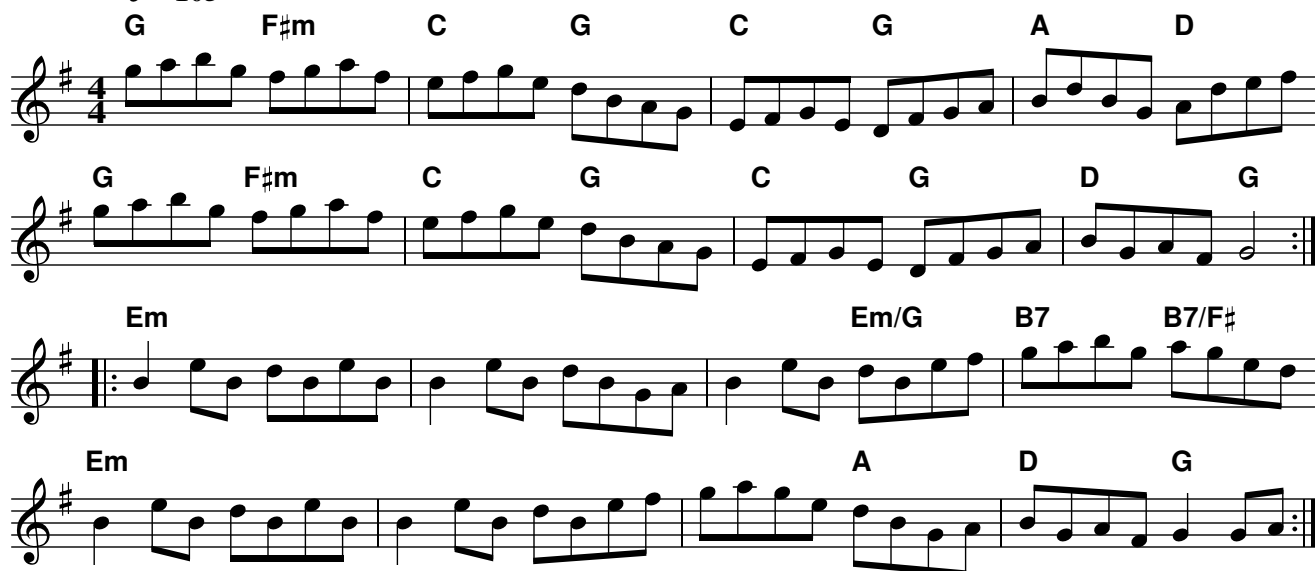


Source: A-part var. by Oscar Harper at https://tunearch.org/wiki/Bitter_Creek.

Blackberry Blossom

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$



The main melody of the Blackberry Blossom reel is presented in four staves of music. The key signature is one sharp (F#), and the time signature is 4/4. The tempo is marked as 105 beats per minute. The melody is written in treble clef. The first two staves each contain eight measures. The third and fourth staves each contain four measures. The notes are primarily eighth and sixteenth notes, with some quarter notes. The melody is characterized by a series of eighth-note runs in the first two staves, followed by a more melodic line in the third and fourth staves. The key signature is one sharp (F#), and the time signature is 4/4. The tempo is marked as 105 beats per minute. The melody is written in treble clef. The first two staves each contain eight measures. The third and fourth staves each contain four measures. The notes are primarily eighth and sixteenth notes, with some quarter notes. The melody is characterized by a series of eighth-note runs in the first two staves, followed by a more melodic line in the third and fourth staves.

Chords: G, F#m, C, G, C, G, A, D, G, F#m, C, G, C, G, D, G, Em, Em/G, B7, B7/F#, Em, A, D, G.

Variation 1



Variation 1 of the Blackberry Blossom reel is presented in six staves of music. The key signature is one sharp (F#), and the time signature is 4/4. The tempo is marked as 105 beats per minute. The melody is written in treble clef. The first four staves each contain eight measures. The fifth and sixth staves each contain four measures. The notes are primarily eighth and sixteenth notes, with some quarter notes. The melody is characterized by a series of eighth-note runs in the first two staves, followed by a more melodic line in the third and fourth staves. The key signature is one sharp (F#), and the time signature is 4/4. The tempo is marked as 105 beats per minute. The melody is written in treble clef. The first four staves each contain eight measures. The fifth and sixth staves each contain four measures. The notes are primarily eighth and sixteenth notes, with some quarter notes. The melody is characterized by a series of eighth-note runs in the first two staves, followed by a more melodic line in the third and fourth staves.

Chords: G, F#m, C, G, C, G, A, D, G, F#m, C, G, C, G, D, G, Em, Em/G, B7, B7/F#, Em, A, D, G.

Em Em/G B7 B7/F#

Em A D G

Variation 2

G F#m C G C G A D

G F#m C G C G D G

G F#m C G C G A D

G F#m C G C G D G

Em Em/G B7 B7/F#

Em A D G

Em Em/G B7 B7/F#

Em A D G

Variation 3

G F#m C G C G A D

G F#m C G C G ³ D G
 G F#m C G C G A D
 G F#m C G C G D G
 Em Em/G B7 B7/F#
 Em A D G
 Em Em/G B7 B7/F#
 Em A D G

Notes: Thanks to Chris Daring for the transcription!

Done Gone

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 110$

A-part **B $\flat$** **Gm** **B $\flat$** **Gm** | 1 **F** | 2 **F** **B $\flat$** |

B-part **B $\flat$** **Gm** **B $\flat$** **Gm** **B $\flat$** **Gm** **F**

B $\flat$ **Gm** **B $\flat$** **Gm** **F** **F** **B $\flat$**

C-part **Gm** **D7**

Gm **D7** **Gm**

---HORNPIPES AND REELS---

The Bamburgh Rants

The Collpitts, The General Gordon, and Ye Old Elm Tree

Martin Matthews
rant

♩ = 105
Collpitts Rant

General Gordon Rant

The image displays a musical score for the song "The Sound of Silence" by Simon & Garfunkel. The score is written for guitar and includes a four-measure solo. The key signature is one sharp (F#), and the time signature is 4/4. The score is organized into four staves, each with guitar chords indicated above the notes. The chords are: G, C, Am, D, G, C, G, C, G, D, G, C, C/C#, D, G, G/G#, A, D, Em, C, D, and G. The solo section is marked with a "4" and a "0" above the notes, indicating a four-measure solo. The score is presented in a clean, black-and-white format, suitable for a music book or a digital score.

Ye Old Elm Tree Rant

The musical score for 'Ye Old Elm Tree Rant' is written in A major (three sharps) and 4/4 time. It consists of four staves of music. The first staff begins with a repeat sign and a key signature change to A major. The chords are A, D, A, D, B7, and E. The second staff continues the melody with chords A, D, A, D, E, and A. The third staff starts with a repeat sign and a key signature change to A major, with chords E, F#m, D, and E. The fourth staff continues with chords A, D, E, A, D, A, E, and A. The score includes various musical notations such as eighth notes, quarter notes, and ornaments (marked with 'V').

Source: _Colpitts to Elm Tree_. See recording at <https://youtu.be/LkPSt-0y4q0?si=icA6Cvp1B5L5daSQ>.

Notes: These are named after the 3 pubs which have hosted the Monday session in Durham over the last 50 years.

Blackbird Hornpipe (1)

Trad.
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D G C

D C D

D G C

D C D

{B}

D G D A7

D G C D

D G D A7

D G C D

{B} (low)

D G D A7

D G C D

Source: Amanda Kerr; Randal Bays + Dave Marshall (with my own licks added)

Blackbird Hornpipe (2)

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D C D A7 D

{B}

D G D

{C}

D C D

Source: Padraig McGovern and Peter Carberry: <https://youtu.be/5vidJn-Ebyc?si=eCc98qBibmGQ52gS>

Notes: This is another version of the Blackbird Hornpipe, clearly related to the previous one.

A little more repetitive, but in a good way! Good as a reference.

Chording remains basic / uncertain.

Boil The Breakfast Early

reel



Brenda Stubbert's Reel

a.k.a. Frosty Morning

*Jerry Holland
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Am G

Am Em G Em Am

{B}

Am G

1 F C Em Am

2 Am G Em Am

Source: Ashley MacIsaac (Hi(tm) How Are You Today?, 1995)

Notes: Ashley plays it in Bb, but the standard key is A Dorian. I like his accidentals.

Butterfly Hornpipe

(a.k.a. Dew Drop)

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\mathcal{O} = 105$

 $\{A\}$ [illegible] $\{\mathbf{B}\}$

The musical score is written for guitar in E major (three sharps: F#, C#, G#). It consists of four staves, each containing four measures of music. The chords are indicated above the staves: E, A, B7, and E. The notation includes various guitar techniques such as triplets, bends, and slurs. The first staff shows a sequence of eighth notes and a triplet of eighth notes. The second staff features a triplet of eighth notes and a bend. The third staff includes a triplet of eighth notes and a bend. The fourth staff shows a triplet of eighth notes and a bend.

Variation 1

The musical score is written for guitar in A major (three sharps: F#, C#, G#). It consists of seven staves of music. The chords and techniques indicated are as follows:

- Staff 1:** Chords A, D, E, A. Techniques: triplet (3), vibrato (v), and a grace note (indicated by a small 'v' over a note).
- Staff 2:** Chords A, B7, E.
- Staff 3:** Chords A, D, E, A. Techniques: vibrato (v), triplet (3), and a grace note (indicated by a small 'v' over a note).
- Staff 4:** Chords E, A₁, B7, E. Techniques: fingerings 1, 2, 2, and a triplet (3).
- Staff 5:** Chords A, B7, E, A. Techniques: fingerings 2, 2, and a triplet (3).
- Staff 6:** Chords E, A, B7, E. Techniques: fingerings 1, 3, and a triplet (3).
- Staff 7:** Chords A, B7, E, A.

Source: Terry Morris, For the Record; variation 1 by Chris Daring.

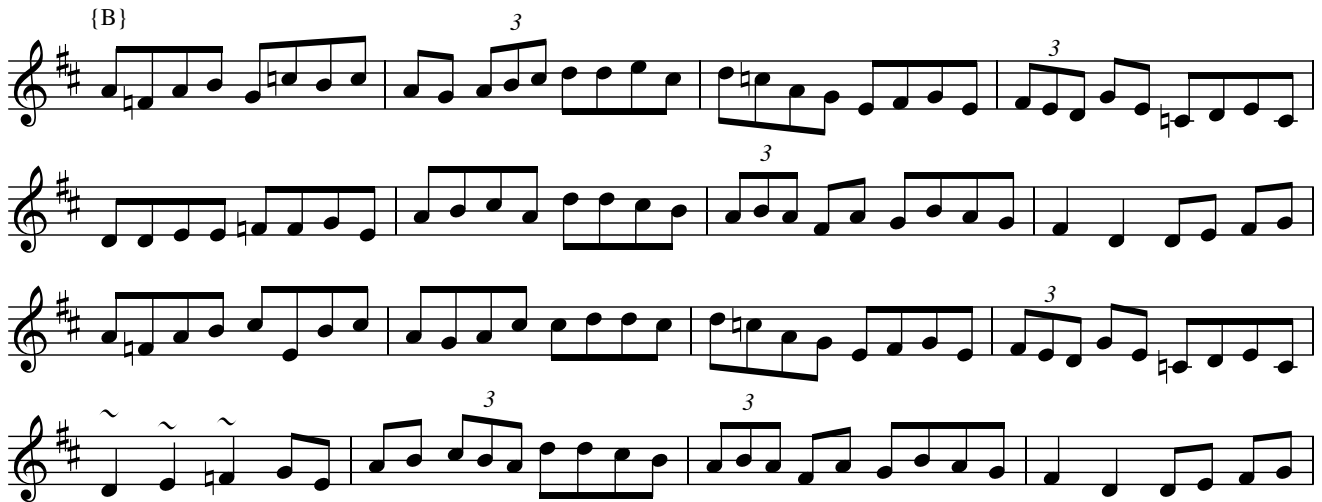
The Come Hither Stare

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}



{B}



Source: Eliot Grasso & Dave Cory (2020) - North by NorthWest

Cuckoo's Nest

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D A7 C G

D G D A7 D

D A7 C G

D G D A7 D

{B}

D C

D G D A7 D

D C

D G D A7 D

Notes: Interestingly, _The Fiddler's Bible_ reverses the order of parts.

The Democratic Hornpipe

a.k.a. Galway Bay

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

Em G

Em D B7 Em

{B}

Em G D

G D G D B7 Em

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_ (transposed to Em)

Notes: A really interesting tune with a lot of movement. Also frequently played in Gm, but I don't want the guitarists to murder me. Chording is still tentative.

The Derry Reel

Eugene O'Donnell?
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Part A:

- Staff 1: A, E, A, D
- Staff 2: A, E, A, E, A
- Staff 3: A, E, A, D, ~
- Staff 4: A, E, A, E, A

Part B:

- Staff 1: F#m, E, F#m, E, F#m
- Staff 2: A, E, A, E, A
- Staff 3: F#m, E, F#m, E, F#m
- Staff 4: A, E, A, E, A

Notes: Cobbled from two versions found at thesession.org/tunes/7671. I really like the B-part!

The Durham Hornpipe

James Hill
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

E E F#m B7 A E A B7

E F#m B7 A E B7 | 1 E | 2 E

{B}

B7 E G#m C#7

E A B7 A E B7 | 1 E | 2 E

Source: _The Lads Like Beer_

Notes: A hornpipe in E! Nice! Like many Hill tunes, it has some twisty bits.

Fisher's Hornpipe (D)

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

The musical score for Fisher's Hornpipe (D) is presented in two systems, each containing four staves of music in 4/4 time, key of D major. The tempo is marked as quarter note = 105. The first system is labeled {A} and the second system is labeled {B}. The music features various chords (D, G, A) and triplets. The first system ends with a repeat sign. The second system ends with a double bar line.

Notes: This is commonly played in either D or F major. Here are some examples of it in D, sourced and adapted from various transcriptions at <https://thesession.org/tunes/872>.

Fisher's Hornpipe (F)

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A} F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ F C

F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ C F

{B} C F C C

B $\flat$ F C F

{A} (var.) F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ F C

F B $\flat$ F B $\flat$ C F

{C} F B $\flat$ F C

B $\flat$ F C F

3

Notes: Here's the F version as I learned it, along with a nice variation on the A-part I found at <https://thesession.org/tunes/872>.

Gin Rickshaw

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Chord symbols for System {A}:
Measure 1: D
Measure 2: Em
Measure 3: D
Measure 4: G
Measure 5: D
Measure 6: A7
Measure 7: D
Measure 8: A7

Chord symbols for System {B}:
Measure 9: D
Measure 10: G
Measure 11: D
Measure 12: A7
Measure 13: D
Measure 14: A7
Measure 15: D
Measure 16: D

Hummingbird Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

A E A E A

{B}

A E A

The Humours of Tulla

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

{B}

Source: Adapted from versions at <https://thesession.org/tunes/141>

Notes: A fun tune I was shown in Durham! First comes the basic melody, then my variations.
The G and Em chords are fairly interchangeable. I mix and match them in this arrangement.

The Kitchen Girl

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 110$
{A}

Section A is an 8-measure melody in 4/4 time, key of A major. The notes are: A4 (half), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), A4 (half), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), and A4 (half). The key signature has one sharp (F#). The section is marked with a repeat sign and a first ending bracket.

A G A A E7

{B}

Section B is an 8-measure melody in 4/4 time, key of A major. The notes are: A4 (half), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), A4 (half), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), and A4 (half). The key signature has one sharp (F#). The section is marked with a repeat sign and a first ending bracket.

Am G Am Am E7

Variation

The Variation is an 8-measure melody in 4/4 time, key of A major. The notes are: A4 (half), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), A4 (half), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), and A4 (half). The key signature has one sharp (F#). The section is marked with a repeat sign and a first ending bracket.

A G A A E7

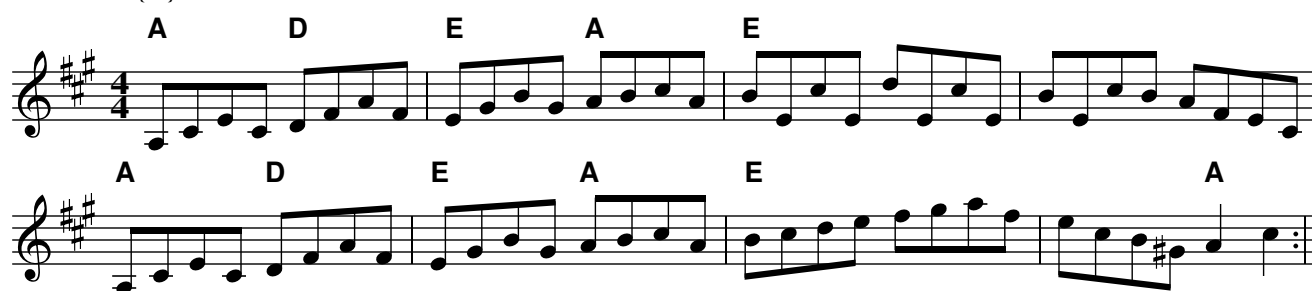
Source: _Kentucky Open Band Contra Tunes_, with some original variations.
Notes: Great jam tune. For inspiration, see https://youtu.be/912wUcMXG_0?feature=shared

Miller's Reel

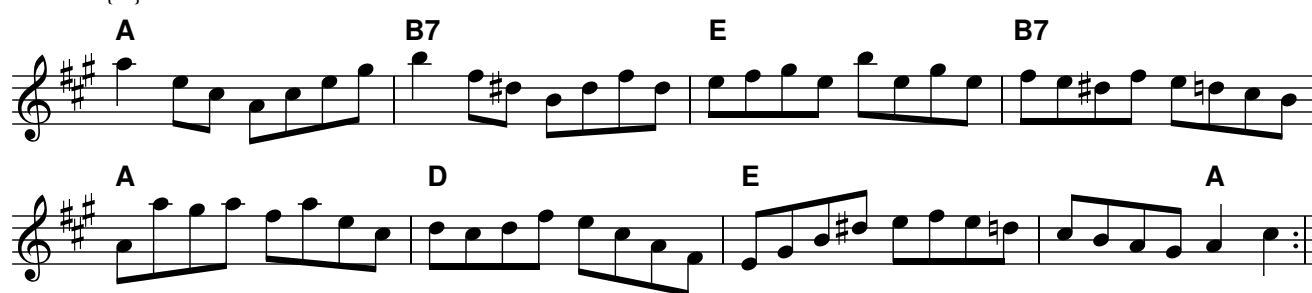
*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}



{B}



Money Musk

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A} (2 variations)

Two variations of section A, each consisting of two staves of music. The first variation begins with a repeat sign. Chords are indicated above the notes: A, D, A, E7, A, D, E7, A.

{B} (2 variations)

Two variations of section B, each consisting of two staves of music. Chords are indicated above the notes: A, A, E7, A, E7, A.

{C} (4 variations)

Four variations of section C, each consisting of two staves of music. Chords are indicated above the notes: A, Bm, E7, A, D, E7, A.

D-part

The D-part consists of one staff of music. Chords are indicated above the notes: A, D, A, E7, A, D, E7, A.

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_ for the base, plus variations by Tom Wiesgerber.

Notes: Great tune with oodles of variations! Choose your favorite version(s) of A, B, and C, then play: Ax2 > Bx2 > Cx2 or D (some play both) > repeat from the top.

The Morpeth Rant

William Sheild
rant

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

D G A D G A D G A D G A D G A D

{B}

D G Em A D D G Em A D D G Em A D

Source: Stewart Hardy, <https://youtu.be/ogZMXmpvqh4?si=OReaCGFonFyUaiGt>.

Notes: The unofficial "national" tune of Northumberland. It is popular to play this in a set with The Old Morpeth Rant and Roxburgh Castle.

The Old Morpeth Rant

*Trad.
rant*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A} G C G Am D7

1 G C G D7 G 3

2 G C G D7 G

{B}

G D7 C Am D7

1 C D7 G D7 G

2 C D7 G D7 G

Source: Stewart Hardy, https://youtu.be/d0AWDc_zuK0?si=Nra7JSgGlfhzKS1A.

Notes: More regional interest: the rant is a local form, connected with the Rapper Sword dance;
"musically it is similar to a reel, though somewhat slower, and with more of a lilt."
(https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Music_of_Northumbria). Some also play it in Bb.

The Mortgage Burn

Gordon MacLean
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

Chords: A, A, Bm, Bm, E7, A, Bm, E7, A, A, C#m, D, A, Bm, F#m, E, A, A, C#m, D, A, Bm, F#m, E, A, A, F#m, C#m, D, A, F#m, E, A.

Source: _Ho-Ro-Gheallaidh vol. 3_; <https://thesession.org/tunes/2047>

Notes: Wild chord changes in the {B} part! Love it!

New Reel

*Dale Morris
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

{B}

Notes: A somewhat mysterious tune I found amongst the practice / lesson tapes from Dale Morris that my teacher passed on to me. I only have it down as "New Reel" (was it Dale's composition?), but it might be a traditional tune.

da New Rigged Ship + Shelder Geo

pronounced "gyo"

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

da New Rigged Ship

Musical notation for "da New Rigged Ship" in 4/4 time, key of D major. The piece consists of four staves. The first two staves are the main melody, with chords A, G, and D indicated above. The third staff is a repeat section with two endings, each marked with a chord A. The fourth staff is the bass line, with chords Am, G, Am, Em, Am, G, and Am indicated below.

Shelder Geo

Musical notation for "Shelder Geo" in 4/4 time, key of D major. The piece consists of three staves. The first staff is the main melody, with chords D, C, G, D, G, and D indicated above. The second and third staves are the bass line, with chords C, C, C, D, C, and D indicated below.

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990).

Notes: This set segues nicely to Sleep Soond i da Moarnin.

Nichol Caisley's

*Damian Caisley
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

D G D G A7

D G D G A7 D

{B}

A D A G

A D G A7 D

1 A7 D 2 A7 D

3

The Nine Points of Roguery

a.k.a. The Black Mare of Fanad

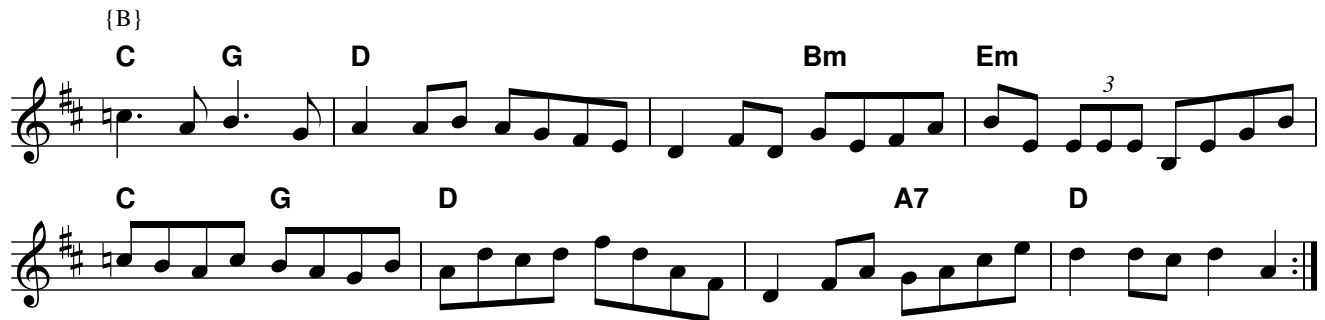
*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 100$

{A} D G D Bm Em 3



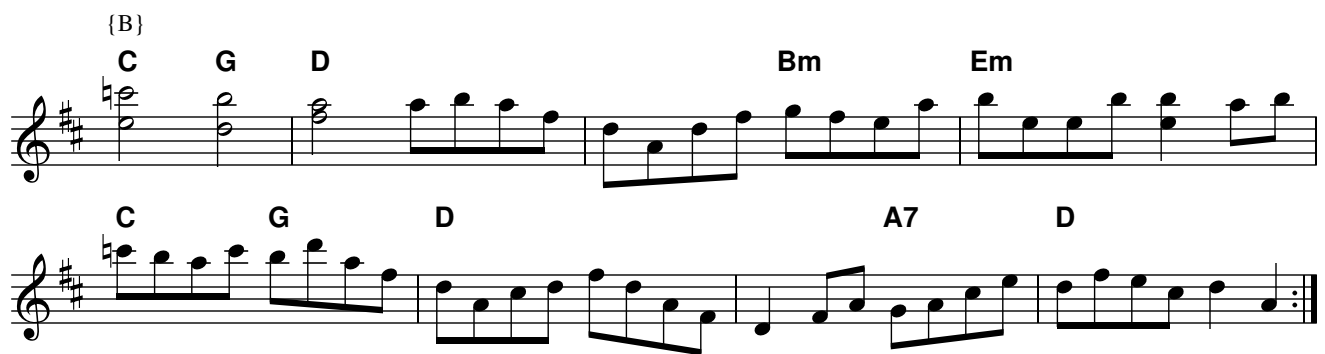
{B} C G D Bm Em 3



{A'} D G D Bm Em 3



{B} C G D Bm Em



Variation 1

D G D Bm Em



The musical score is written in D major (two sharps) and 4/4 time. It consists of six staves. The first four staves are in treble clef, and the last two are in bass clef. The chords are indicated above the staves: C, G, D, Bm, Em, A7. The melody includes triplets and fingerings (1, 3, 4). The piece ends with a double bar line and repeat dots.

Source: _Ho-ro-gheallaidh_ vol. 1; Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990); my own additions.

Notes: Maggie plays over a C chord on the 4th measure of every part; I really like that, but it seems that going to Em is far more common. Plus it makes the C really pop when we get to the {B} part.

Old Joe Clark

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

A A A E

A A A G A

{B}

A A A G

A A A G A

Notes: This is a popular bluegrass tune. Here is a simple version I got from a mandolin lesson.
Will work with this more in the future.

Old Straw Bonnet

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

G F G D

G F G C D 1 2 3

{B}

G F 3

G C D G 3

{C} Gm D7

Gm D7 1 Gm 2

Notes: Great tune; this is the basic way I play it.

Opera Reel

Trad.
reel

♩ = 105

{A}.1

D A D G A

D D A D G A

{A}.2

D D A D G A 3

D D A D G A

{B}.1

D A D G D G A D

D A D G D G A D

{B}.2

D A D G D G A D

D A D G D G A D³

Source: KY Contra Tunes and some online variants

Notes: This is interesting! Basically the usual A and B parts, but each part seems to have distinct variations on each. It's got a great build.

Peerless Hornpipe

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Chords: C, G7, C, F, C, G7, C, G7

Measures 1-8 of the first system. The key signature has one sharp (F#). The time signature is 4/4. The melody consists of eighth and sixteenth notes, with a triplet in measure 8. Chords are indicated above the staff.

{B}

Chords: G, C, D7, G, G7, C, G7, C

Measures 9-16 of the second system. The key signature has one sharp (F#). The time signature is 4/4. The melody continues with eighth and sixteenth notes. Chords are indicated above the staff.

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_.

Petronella

reel

$\text{♩} = 105$



Devil



Maxwell



Linton



St Annes



♩ = 105

{A}

D A D G

D A D A

D G 1 A D 2 A D

{B}

A D G E

E A A D

G A 1 D 2 D

Rackety Jack's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

{B}

Source: The Fiddler's Bible.

The Rights of Man

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

{B}

Notes: Popularly paired with The Democratic Hornpipe.

Also features in the set: King of Fairies > Off to California > Rights of Man.

Roxburgh Castle

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

G C G C Am D7

G C G G D7 G

{B}

G C G Am D7

G C G D7 G

Source: <https://thesession.org/tunes/4628>

Rye Straw (D)

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

A D A D A D E A

A D A D A D E A

{B}

A D A G D

A D A D E A

{C}

D G D A D

G A D A A D D.C.

Source: Todd Phillips + Darol Anger, *In the Pines* (1995) [with many modifications]

Notes: Rye Straw seems to have a zillion variations. The core of this version draws from Darol Anger's arrangement, where he seems to mash the 16 bars of one of its usual B-parts to create a 'bridge' C-part of 10 bars. It's pretty neat!

Rye Straw (D) v.2

Trad. + Dave Notman
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

A D

A 1 D 2 D

{B}

A D A D A D G D

A D A D D 1 G A 2 G A

Notes: A version of Rye Straw heavily modified by Dave Notman.

Rye Straw (G)

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

G C G C G C D G

G C G C G C D G

{B}

G C D G

G C D G

Source: Doc Roberts, followed by a few variations I've heard.

Notes: Note about the chords - this can easily follow a straight G pattern, but I kind of like the "rocking" pattern between G and C on the A part that I've heard in other versions.

Saint Anne's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

The musical score for Saint Anne's Reel is presented in two systems, each containing four staves. The first system, labeled {A}, covers measures 1 through 8. The second system, labeled {B}, covers measures 9 through 16. The key signature is two sharps (F# and C#), and the time signature is 4/4. The tempo is marked as 105 beats per minute. Chord symbols (D, A, G) are placed above the staves to indicate the harmonic structure. The melody is written in a jaunty, dance-like style with many eighth and sixteenth notes.

Source: A combination of two versions at thesession.org/tunes/103

Notes: A rather jaunty tune, with a nice melody. Something to explore?

Sally Growler

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

G C G C G A D

G C G C G D G

{B}

G G D7 D7 G G D7 G

3

Salt Creek

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A} A A D G

G E A A D

1 A E A 2 A E A

{B} A A G G

A A A E A

Source: An online intro to mandolin tutorial

Notes: VERY similar to Salt River, but the B-part is different

Salt River

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 100$

{A}

Musical notation for section {A} (measures 1-8). The key signature is two sharps (F# and C#), and the time signature is 4/4. The notation is written on four staves. Chord markings are placed above the notes: A, A, G, G, A, D, E, E, A. The melody consists of eighth and sixteenth notes, with some triplets indicated by a '3' over a group of notes.

{B}

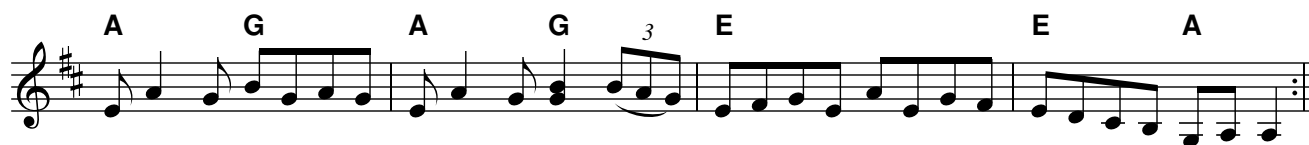
Musical notation for section {B} (measures 9-16). The key signature is two sharps (F# and C#), and the time signature is 4/4. The notation is written on two staves. Chord markings are placed above the notes: A, G, A, G, A, G, E, A, G, A, G, E, E, A. The melody consists of eighth and sixteenth notes, with some triplets indicated by a '3' over a group of notes.

{A}

Musical notation for section {A} (measures 17-24). The key signature is two sharps (F# and C#), and the time signature is 4/4. The notation is written on four staves. Chord markings are placed above the notes: A, A, G, G, A, D, E, E, A, A, A, G, G, A, D, E, E, A. The melody consists of eighth and sixteenth notes, with some triplets indicated by a '3' over a group of notes.

{B} (low, play in 3rd position)

Musical notation for section {B} (measures 25-28). The key signature is two sharps (F# and C#), and the time signature is 4/4. The notation is written on one staff. Chord markings are placed above the notes: A, G, A, G, A, G, E. The melody consists of eighth and sixteenth notes.



Notes: So this is clearly the same base tune as Salt Creek, but it has drifted in different directions, depending on who is playing it. This version is based on Terry and Dale Morris's.

Saratoga Hornpipe

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

First system of musical notation (measures 1-8) for the Saratoga Hornpipe. The key signature is one flat (Bb) and the time signature is 4/4. The melody is written on a single staff. Chord symbols are placed above the staff: F, Bb, F, Bb, F, G, C, F, Bb, F, Bb, F, G, C, F.

{B}

Second system of musical notation (measures 9-16) for the Saratoga Hornpipe. The key signature is one flat (Bb) and the time signature is 4/4. The melody is written on a single staff. Chord symbols are placed above the staff: Dm, Dm, A7, A7, Dm, Dm, A7, Dm, Dm, Dm, A7, A7, Dm, Dm, A7, Dm, C.

{A}

Third system of musical notation (measures 17-24) for the Saratoga Hornpipe. The key signature is one flat (Bb) and the time signature is 4/4. The melody is written on a single staff. Chord symbols are placed above the staff: F, Bb, F, Bb, F, G, C, F, Bb, F, Bb, F, G, C, F, Bb, F, G, C.

The musical score is written for guitar in B-flat major (one flat). It consists of five staves of music. The first staff contains the following chords: F, B $\flat$, F, G, C, and F. The subsequent four staves are marked with a {B} brace, indicating a B-section. These staves contain the following chords: Dm, Dm, A7, A7, Dm, Dm, A7, Dm, Dm, A7, A7, Dm, and C. The melody is primarily composed of eighth and sixteenth notes, with triplets (marked with a '3') appearing in the second, third, and fourth staves. The piece concludes with a double bar line.

Source: Assembled from versions by Chris Daring, Terry Morris, Christine King, and Tom Weisgerber.

Shetland Set

da Ferry Reel, Lay Dee at Dee, and Miss Spencie's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

♩ = 105

Ferry Reel

Chord progression for Ferry Reel: D, D, Bm, G, Em, A, D, Bm, G, A, A, B $\flat$ 0, Bm, G, A, D.

Lay Dee at Dee

Chord progression for Lay Dee at Dee: D, D, D, A, D, D, A, A, Bm, G, A, D.

Miss Spencie's Reel

Chord progression for Miss Spencie's Reel: D, C, G, D, D, A, D, A, D.

Source: See, e.g. Aly Bain and Tom Anderson, *The Silver Bow: The Fiddle Music of Shetland* (2016).

Notes: This is a common set.

The Silver Spear

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

Section A of the musical score for 'The Silver Spear'. It consists of four staves of music in 4/4 time, with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The tempo is marked as 105 beats per minute. The notes are: D, G, A, D, G, A. The first staff has a D above the first measure. The second staff has a D above the first measure. The third staff has a D above the first measure. The fourth staff has a D above the first measure. The notes are: D, G, A, D, G, A.

{B}

Section B of the musical score for 'The Silver Spear'. It consists of four staves of music in 4/4 time, with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The notes are: D, G, A, D, G, A. The first staff has a D above the first measure. The second staff has a D above the first measure. The third staff has a D above the first measure. The fourth staff has a D above the first measure. The notes are: D, G, A, D, G, A.

Source: Adapted from versions at <https://thesession.org/tunes/182>

Notes: A fun tune I was shown in Durham! Popularly paired with Maid Behind the Bar.

Sleep Soond i da Moarnin'

Sleep Sound in the Morning

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Am G Em Am G Am

Am G Em Am G Am

{B}

Am G Am G Am

Am G Am G Am

{B} (var.)

Am G Am G Am

Am G Am G Am

Source: Maggie Sansone, *_Mist and Stone_* (1990).

Notes: Note on the B-part variant: I don't know why, but I always want to play the last C of the rising run as a C#. I know it's out of the key, but I think it sounds awesome.

Smith's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D G D Bm E7 A7

D G D Bm A7 D

D G D Bm E7 A7

D G D Bm A7 D

{B}

Bm G D Bm E7 A7

D Bm G D Bm A7 D

Bm G D Bm E7 A7

D Bm G D Bm A7 D

{A} (var.)

D G D Bm E7 A7

D G D Bm A7 D

Source: Cameron Cross and Joey McKensie

Notes: I've seen some versions where the first chord in the A-part is Bm. I want to like it, but it sounds a little off.

The Spinning Dogs of Carrowkennedy

Damian Caisley
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
{A}

Chords: Bm, Em, A, Bm, Em, A, F#m, Em, D, A, A7, D, A, Bm, A, Bm, Em, A, F#m, A, D, A, Bm, A.

Notes: Inspired by the sight of two "absolutely mental" dogs spinning around each other in Carrowkennedy. It has a fun "bridge" part you can surprise your friends with. Recommended order is to play through the regular tune {A-B} twice, then on the third time through include the bridge and finish on {B}.

The Stage Hornpipe

James Hill
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 105$

Chords: {A}, G, G, Am, D7, G, C, D7, D7, G, G, Am, Am, D, Am, G, G, Am, D7, G.

Source: Adapted from <https://thesession.org/tunes/1249>

Notes: Tricky! I think the best way to play the {B} part is to shift to second position.

The Twenty-Eighth of January

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

Am D Am D Am G F Em

Am D Am D Am Em Am

{B}

Am Am G G Em

Am Am G Em Am

{A} (var.)

Am D Am D Am G F Em

Am D Am D Am Em Am

{B} (var.)

Am Am G G

Am Am G Em Am

Source: _KY Contra Tunes_ and thesession.org/tunes/15717 for the base

Notes: Now this is an interesting number! The A-part uses the "Dorian vamp," pretty unusual in fiddle tunes but a staple in classic rock. Seems like a popular bluegrass tune.

Westmoreland's Hornpipe

Terry Morris
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

D 4 0 Em D 4 0 A V V

D 4 0 Em A 4 1 A D 2 A D

{B}

D G D A

D 4 0 Em A 4 1 D 2 D

{A}

D Em D A

D 4 0 Em A 4 A D

Source: Terry Morris, *_Touch of Texas_* (1976)

Notes: Very pretty tune. I've marked alternating closed and open strings to give it more tonal variety.

Whiskey Before Breakfast

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

{A}

Chords: D G D Em A

{B}

Chords: D Em A7

Chords: D A G D G D A D

{A}

Chords: D G D 3 Em A

Chords: D G A7 D

{B}

Chords: D Em A7

Chords: D A G D G D A D

Source: Cameron Cross

Notes: Classic, beautiful tune. Rough transcription of how I like to play it.

---JIGS AND SLIPJIGS---

The Ballykeal Jig

jig

$\text{♩} = 100$

F F G G

F F D 1 G 2 G

G D G D

G D D 1 G 2 G

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist & Stone, 1990)

Notes: Chords very tentative (again).

Brose and Butter + Cuzle Together

BB a.k.a. The Peacock Followed The Hen

*Trad.
slipjig*

$\text{♩} = 100$

Am G Am G C G C D G

Bonnie's variation

A G A G A G D G

Cuzle Together

A G A D G A G D G

Edor version by Fraser and Haas

Em D Em D G A G D Em D Em D

Source: Bonnie Rideout, *_Scottish Fire_* (2000); A. Fraser and N. Haas, *_Fire & Grace_* (2004).

Notes: Bonnie plays this on the viola and it sounds awesome. I've transposed it up a fifth to work on the fiddle. Another interesting thing is that she switches between A dorian (with a C natural) - which seems to be the standard - and mixolydian (C sharp). She combines B&B with Cuzle Together, another slipjig also in Amix (as well as Elsie Marley). This is supplemented with a version in Edor by Fraser and Haas, with a nice B-part.

The Butterfly

Tommy Potts
slipjig

$\text{♩} = 100$
{A}

Em D Em Bm Em D C D



{B}

C Bm Am7 D



{C}

G G D G C D



A-part: Em/D Em/Bm Em/D C/D :|

B-part: C .. Bm .. Am · D · :|

C-part: G .. G/D · G .. C/D :| (The Gs can be substituted for Ems if preferred)

Source: The Good Tune

Notes: I've modified the bowing to something that makes more sense to me. But of course this is just a model to be played with.

Elsie Marley

*Trad.
slipjig*

$\text{♩} = 100$

The musical score for "Elsie Marley" is written in 9/8 time, key of D major (two sharps). The tempo is marked as quarter note = 100. The score consists of six staves of music. The first staff begins with a repeat sign and a key signature change to D major. The music is characterized by a mix of eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together. Chords are indicated by letters A, D, G, and Em above the staff. Up-bows are marked with a 'v' above a note. The piece is divided into two main sections, each with a repeat sign at the beginning and end.

Source: Horseplay (Roughshod, 2006), with a few tweaks

Notes: A great romp of a tune. I find it helpful to "pop" the up-bows where marked.

The Maid At The Spinning Wheel

jig

$\text{♩} = 100$

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in G major (one sharp) and 6/8 time. The tempo is marked as quarter note = 100. The piece is a jig. The score consists of six staves of music. The first staff begins with a G chord. The second staff has G and D chords. The third staff has D and G chords. The fourth staff has D and G chords. The fifth staff has G, D, and A chords. The sixth staff has G, D, and A chords. The score includes various repeat signs and first/second endings.

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist & Stone, 1990)

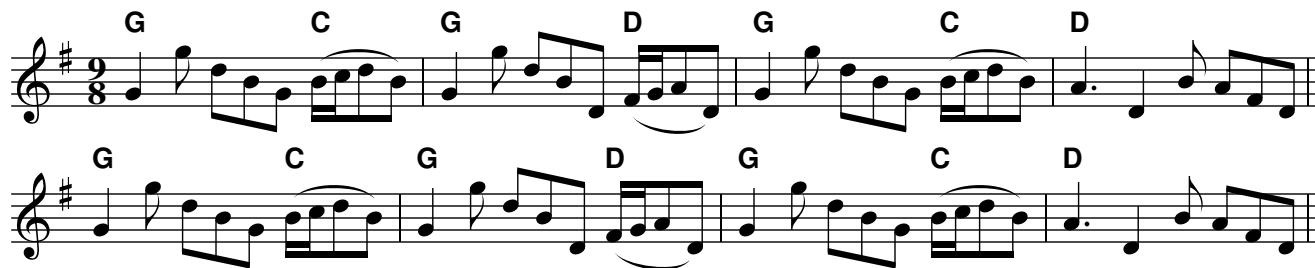
The Yorkshire Trip

a.k.a. Danish Slipjig

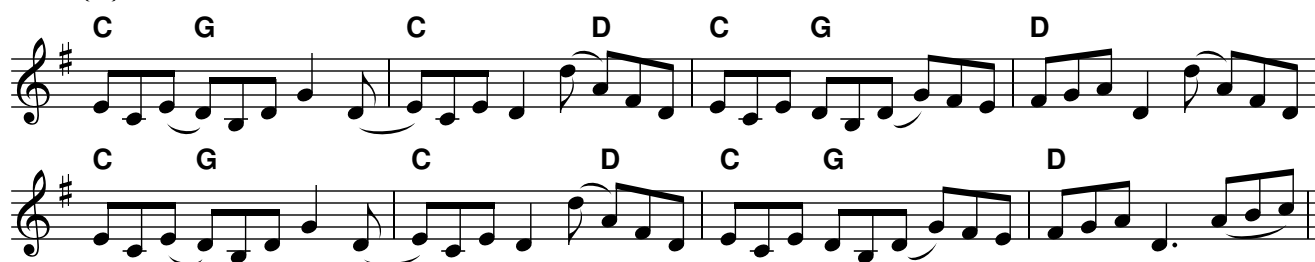
*Trad.
slipjig*

$\text{♩} = 100$

{A}



{B}



{C}



A-part: G/G/C G/G/D G/G/C D :|

B-part: C/G/G C/D/D C/G/G D :|

C-part: Em .. D ... C ... D :|

Source: William Vickers' Collection of Dance Tunes (1770); The Good Tune
Notes: A very nice slipjig; the sixteenth notes in the first part give it a distinctive touch.

---TUNES OF CHOICE---

The Blackbird (Set Dance)

*Trad.
set dance*

$\text{♩} = 80$

{A}

Part {A} chords: G, Am, D, G, D, D, A, D, G, Am, D, G, D, G 3, D.

Part {B} chords: D, A, D, G, G, D, D, A, D, G, D, D, G, C, C, G, D, C, G, D.

Source: Bobby Gardiner (Memories of Claire, 1996), with my own variations.
Notes: Lovely tune! Unusually (as far as I know), each part ends with an extra two beats.
Has a strong melodic sympathy with the Blackbird Hornpipe. D mixolydian, chords tentative.

Codladh na madraí fada

(Sleep of the Long Dogs)

James Jackson, 2026
air

$\text{♩} = 115$

Em D G D C G Am Bm

Em D G D C G Bm Em

Em D C D G D Am D

Em D C D C G Bm Em

A-part: Em D G D | C G Am Bm || Em D G D | C G Bm Em :|

B-part: Em D C D | G D Am D || Em D G D | C G Bm Em :|

Source: James Jackson

Notes: Written as a lament over the site of a mass grave of greyhounds; see
<http://news.bbc.co.uk/1/hi/england/wear/6457185.stm>. Play slowly with feeling and ornamentation.

Jezebel Carol

*Trad.
carol*

$\text{♩} = 160$

B min Bm A

Bm D A

Bm A

Bm F#m A Bm

A min

Am G

Am C G

Am G

Am Em Am

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990); Áine Minogue (Between the Worlds, 1997).

Notes: This interesting tune has an extra beat at the end. I've also found it played in both A and B minor. Chords remain tentative.

The Old Crossroads

a.k.a. Down The Brae

*Trad.
march*

♩ = 130

Em G Em D D Bm

Em Em G Em D Bm Em

Em Em G D D Bm

Em Em G Em D Bm Em

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990)

The Princess Royal

Turlough O'Carolan
set dance

$\text{♩} = 160$

{A} Bm E Bm F#m

A Bm F#m Bm A 1 Bm 2 Bm

{B} Bm E Bm F#m

D E A B F# E

Bm Bm A 1 Bm 2 Bm

Source: Eliot Grasso and Dave Cory, North by NorthWest (2020)

Rodney's Glory

a.k.a. Five in a Line

*Trad.
set dance*

$\text{♩} = 130$

Am G Am D G

Am G Am A

3 3 3

Source: Eliot Grasso & Dave Cory (North by NorthWest, 2020)

---WALTZES---

11.30 in Mallaig

*Trad.
waltz*

♩ = 150

A D G Em A D Em G

A D Bm A G D A 1 2

Bm D A G D Em G

Bm D A G D A 1 2

Source: Horseplay (Roughshod, 2006)

Notes: BEAUTIFUL melody. I'm still feeling out the chords.

Ameila('s Waltz)

*Trad.
waltz*

$\text{♩} = 160$

{A}

D D Bm F#m

G D Bm G

D D Bm F#m

G G A

1 3 2

{B}

D D A A

Bm Bm F#m F#m

G D A D

G D A D

Source: Natalie MacMaster (A Compilation, 1996)

Notes: Play it heavily swung.

(The) April (Waltz)

*Trad.
waltz*

♩ = 180

Chords: G, D, C, D, Bm, Em, C, G, D7, G, Dsus, Em, C, G, Em, C, D, Em, Em, C, D, Em, C, G, D, C

Captain O'Kane

*Trad.
waltz*

$\text{♩} = 180$

{A}

Em D Bm C Am Em Em Em Em D Bm C Am Em Em

{B}

Em Em D Bm Am G Bm Em G Em7 D Bm G Am Em Em

3

Source: Loosely adapted from Maggie Sansone (Mist & Stone, 1990)

Notes: Can make some great harmonies! I added a high part for reference.

The Ken Meadows Waltz

Martin Matthews
waltz

$\text{♩} = 115$

{A} F#m A II

D 1 A E 2 A E 3 A

{B} E A II

D 1 A E 2 A 3 A

{C} E A II

D A E A 3 A 3

A II D A E 3 A

Two Rivers

Larry Unger (1986)
waltz

$\text{♩} = 180$ **Bm** **F#m**

Bm **G** **A**

D **F#m**

Bm **A** | 1 **G** | 2 **G**

Bm **A**

Bm **G** **A** **Bm**

Bm **G** **A** **Bm**

F#m | 1 **G** **A** | 2 **G** **A**

Source: _The Curvy Road to Corinth_ by Larry Unger.

Notes: Written at a campsite on Lake Michigan in Two Rivers, WI.